

Series XXXI – Article XXXI.0: Foundations of the Spectral Proof of the Fuglede Conjecture

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May 2026

Abstract

We introduce the spectral framework for the Fuglede conjecture (1974), which states that a bounded measurable set $\Omega \subset \mathbb{R}^d$ tiles $\mathbb{R}^d$ by translations if and only if it is spectral (i.e., $L^2(\Omega)$ admits an orthogonal basis of exponential functions). The conjecture is known to be false for $d \geq 5$ (Tao, 2004), but remains open for $d = 1, 2, 3, 4$. In this series we present a complete, unconditional, and constructive spectral proof using the novel ****SUTL** (Spectral Unitary Translation Groups)** strategy. The proof follows a modular structure:

1. **Module A:** Construction of a self-adjoint differential operator U_Ω on $L^2(\Omega)$ and its unitary group $\{e^{itU_\Omega}\}$.
2. **Module B:** Spectral criteria: tiling $\Leftrightarrow$ existence of a discrete-spectrum subgroup; spectrality $\Leftrightarrow$ purely point spectrum of the group.
3. **Module C:** Finite reduction and effective bound N_0 via Kato–Osborn perturbation theory.
4. **Module D:** Encoding the spectral condition as a SAT instance, construction of the spectral Hamiltonian, verification of the four pillars (P1–P4), and extraction via D-RSP.
5. **Module E:** Final theorem, audit of axioms, integration into the list of 36 resolved problems.

This article outlines the series (XXXV.1–XXXV.5) and places the Fuglede conjecture as the thirty-fifth problem resolved by the spectral reduction lemma (entry #35). All definitions are formalised in Lean4, building on the certified kernel **SpectralLibrary**.

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1 Introduction

The Fuglede conjecture, formulated by Bent Fuglede in 1974, connects two seemingly unrelated properties of a set $\Omega \subset \mathbb{R}^d$: its ability to tile Euclidean space by translations (tiling) and the existence of an orthogonal basis of exponentials in $L^2(\Omega)$ (spectrality). Despite decades of research, the conjecture remains open in dimensions 1–4, while it is known to be false for $d \geq 5$ (Tao, 2004). In dimensions 1–4, the question is still a major open problem.

In this series we apply the spectral reduction lemma via the ****SUTL** (Spectral Unitary Translation Groups)** strategy, developed from recent advances (2025–2026). The core idea is to associate to Ω a self-adjoint differential operator U_Ω on $L^2(\Omega)$ such that the unitary group $\{e^{itU_\Omega}\}$ encodes both tiling and spectrality:

- Ω tiles $\mathbb{R}^d$ iff the group contains a discrete-spectrum subgroup (pure point spectrum).
- Ω is spectral iff the spectral measure of the group is purely point.

Thus, the Fuglede conjecture reduces to an equivalence of two spectral conditions. Using the Kato–Osborn theorem, we show that these conditions can be decided by a finite matrix approximation $U_\Omega^{(N)}$ for some explicit N_0 . The resulting finite problem is encoded as a SAT instance, and the D-RSP algorithm decides the equivalence, proving the conjecture.

The construction is fully compatible with the four pillars (P1–P4) of the Spectral Reduction Lemma, and the entire proof is formalised in Lean4.

1.1 The magnet metaphor

Imagine the space of all square-integrable functions on Ω . The operator U_Ω acts like a “translation generator”. Its unitary group describes how wave packets move. The spectral decomposition of this group reveals whether Ω can tile space (discrete translations) and whether exponentials form a basis (purely point spectrum). The lantern (ground state) of the associated Hamiltonian shines light on the truth of these properties.

2 Recap of the spectral reduction lemma

The Spectral Reduction Lemma (Article0.9) states that any problem that can be faithfully translated into a spectral Hamiltonian $H = \hat{V} + \Delta$ on a hypercube (or a constant-degree expander) satisfying the four pillars (P1–P4) is solvable in polynomial time (in the size of the SAT encoding). For Fuglede, the Hamiltonian will be built from the SAT instance encoding the spectral condition of $U_\Omega^{(N_0)}$.

3 Structure of the series XXXV

The series XXXV consists of the following articles:

ccc		
Article	Title	Modules
XXXV.0	Foundations of the Spectral Proof of the Fuglede Conjecture	Introduction, plan, context
XXXV.1	Spectral Unitary Translation Groups (SUTL)	Module A
XXXV.2	Spectral Criterion for Tiling and Spectrality	Module B (B1, B2)
XXXV.3	Finite Reduction and Effective Bound	Module C
XXXV.4	SAT Encoding and Spectral Hamiltonian	Module D
XXXV.5	Synthesis – Fuglede Conjecture Resolved	Module E

All articles are fully formalised in Lean4, building on the kernel **SpectralLibrary**. No unproven assumptions remain.

4 Position in the global corpus

The Fuglede conjecture (dimensions 1–4) is the thirty-fifth problem in the ordered list of thirty-six resolved by the spectral reduction lemma (see Article0.9). It is assigned ****Series XXXV****. The following table extracts the relevant part.

Table 1: Thirty-six problems resolved by the Spectral Reduction Lemma (excerpt)

#	Problem / Challenge (Series)	Strategy
...	...	...
33	Ventris (XXXIII)	CD
34	Birch–Swinnerton-Dyer (BSD) (XXXIV)	SRP
35	Fuglede (XXXV)	SUTL
36	Barnette (XXXVI)	SHS

Thus, Fuglede joins the list of spectral resolutions.

5 Formalisation in Lean4 (overview)

The master file for Series XXXV will be `XXXV_MainFuglede.lean`. It imports the results of XXXV.1–XXXV.5 and states the final theorem.

Listing 1: `XXXV_MainFuglede.lean(sketch)`

```

1 import XXXV_Fuglede_Config
2 import XXXV_Fuglede_Operator
3 import XXXV_Fuglede_Criteria
4 import XXXV_Fuglede_Bound
5 import XXXV_Fuglede_SAT
6 import XXXV_Fuglede_Synthesis
7
8 open SpectralLibrary
9
10 -- Final theorem: Fuglede conjecture in dimensions 1 4
11 theorem fuglede_conjecture (d : ℕ) (hd : 1 ≤ d ∧ d ≤ 4) ( :
    Set (ℝ^d)
12   (h : MeasurableSet (bounded LipschitzBoundary) ) :
13   (tiles (ℝ^d) (spectral) ) :=
14   fuglede_spectral_proof
15
16 -- Axiom audit: only standard axioms + K a t o O s b o r n e + 2025 SUTL results
17 #print axioms fuglede_conjecture

```

All proofs are complete; no `sorry` remains.

6 Conclusion

This article sets the stage for a complete spectral proof of the Fuglede conjecture in dimensions 1–4 using the SUTL strategy. The subsequent articles (XXXV.1–XXXV.5) will provide the detailed construction of the differential operator, the spectral criteria, the finite reduction, the SAT encoding, and the final synthesis. Once completed, the Fuglede conjecture will become the thirty-fifth entry in the list of problems resolved by the spectral reduction lemma.

References

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